



Cambridge International Examinations
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/13

Paper 1 Reading Passages (Core)

May/June 2015

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passages for use with **all** the questions on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning.
This Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Part 1

Read **Passage A** carefully, and then answer **Questions 1** and **2** on the Question Paper.

Passage A: Encounters With Ice Bears

In the following passage the writer, Michelle Paver, describes her experience of meeting polar bears in a remote part of Canada.

The Inuit name for the polar bear is Nanuq: the most feared and respected of all Arctic creatures. And no wonder. The polar bear is the largest land predator in the world, and an incredibly skilled hunter, equally at home on ice, a mountain, or in the sea. Unlike the grizzly or black bears, which usually leave people alone if they behave themselves, polar bears quite naturally regard a solitary human being as prey.

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As soon as I arrived at the town of Churchill in Canada, I put on my winter gear and went for a walk. I was warned not to go out into the scrubland beyond the town, in case I met a bear. It's always best to heed local advice, especially when it concerns polar bears, so instead I headed towards the broad, snowy main street. I turned down a side-road, hoping to dip my hand in the waters of Hudson Bay. A large sign warned me back: POLAR BEAR ALERT – STOP! I decided to pay attention, and turned back.

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Even in town, I knew that I could get unlucky and meet a bear, and I often saw a small truck bearing the logo, 'Polar Bear Patrol' crawling through town, keeping a lookout 24 hours a day. I was told that if I did meet a bear, I should duck into the nearest house. In Churchill, nobody locks their doors. I learned, too, that the previous year, a curious bear had battered down the front door of a house, to see what was inside. Luckily, nobody was hurt. In Churchill, most householders keep a loaded gun close by, for the purpose of scaring off bears.

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Night fell: a beautiful, crisp Arctic night, glittering with stars. I really wanted to go for a solitary, moonlit walk, but I decided against it. This turned out to have been a good idea. A little later, a polar bear clambered on to the balcony of my guest-house, and had to be chased away with shots fired into the air.

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To get closer to polar bears without being eaten, I went out in what's called a 'tundra buggy' – a large truck, but with an open-air viewing platform made of strong metal mesh stuck on to the back. This platform is a metre above the snow, so that polar bears can't jump up and eat occupants.

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The first time we went out was at night, and the moon and headlights lit up the humped, snowy scrubland for kilometres around – but no bears. Then, as I stood on the open-air platform peering into the gloom, one of the 'humps' about ten metres away rose and ambled towards me. What struck me most about the bear was its silence. The enormous creature was walking across a crisp snow-crust and yet his huge paws made not a sound – my hiking boots would have crunched loudly with every step.

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In the days that followed, I watched bears by night: playing like giant children in the snow, or sleeping in the seaweed at the edge of the bay, and by day: sparring, lounging, eating ice to keep cool (it was only –8C, too warm for them!). Most memorably of all, on one freezing, snowy afternoon, a young male meandered under the grille of the platform on which I stood. I knelt down. He gazed up at me. For a few heart-stopping minutes, we locked gazes. I'll never forget the look in those strangely innocent, dark eyes.

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Part 2

Read **Passage B** carefully, and then answer **Question 3** on the Question Paper.

Passage B: Endangered Animals: Polar Bears

The following passage is adapted from a website which raises awareness of endangered species and the importance of protecting them.

Polar bears have heavy white fur on their bodies, which insulates them from the extreme cold. They are swift runners, and usually cover hundreds of kilometres. They are also expert swimmers. They are found throughout the arctic region, and are the first animal to be categorized as endangered because of global warming. Their life span is about 25 years.

A polar bear's diet generally consists of fish, seal, caribou, birds, seaweed, and grass. Sometimes they feed themselves on a whale, which has lost its way and come near to the shore.

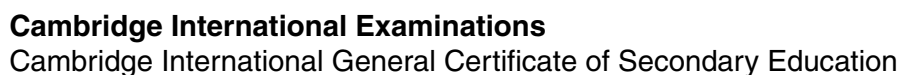
According to the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) and the Endangered Species Act (ESA), polar bears are threatened with extinction. Habitat loss of the polar bears due to climate change is the major cause of their being endangered. In addition to this, they are excessively hunted for their hides, which are priceless. It is believed that only 20,000–25,000 polar bears are alive in the wild.

Extracting oil from below the Arctic Ocean also threatens the survival of polar bears. The process spreads toxic chemicals in the seawaters, and pollutes the surroundings. This makes it difficult for the endangered animals such as polar bears to hunt for their food. Moreover, unregulated sport hunting from aircraft is a further reason for polar bears becoming an endangered species.

Polar bears are free roaming creatures, so they are difficult to protect. To check the decreasing numbers of polar bears, an international agreement was signed in 1973 which allows the use of only traditional weapons for the hunting of polar bears.

The World Wildlife Federation (WWF) is a leader in the conservation of polar bears. It has started an adoption programme to save the endangered animals.

In the past, damage caused to the environment by humans happened as a result of ignorance. But now that we are aware of its negative consequences, it is our responsibility to correct it. We have the capability to do this and a duty to make changes because we will be responsible for the world we leave to our children.



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0500/13

May/June 2015

1 hour 45 minutes

No Additional Materials are required.

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

DO NOT WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passages for use with **all** questions on this Question Paper.
The Reading Booklet Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **9** printed pages, **3** blank pages and **1** Insert.

Read carefully **Passage A, *Encounters With Ice Bears***, in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer **Questions 1 and 2** on this Question Paper.

Answer all questions using your own words as far as possible.

Question 1

- (a) Which one word in paragraph one has a similar meaning to 'predator'?

.....[1]

- (b) State **two** details about the town of Churchill that tell you the authorities there take the danger of Polar Bears seriously (lines 10–13).

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•[2]

- (c) **Using your own words**, explain the ways in which the residents of Churchill attempt to protect themselves from Polar Bear attacks (lines 14–17).

.....

.....

.....[2]

- (d) (i) **Using your own words**, describe the 'tundra buggy' in which the writer went out to search for Polar Bears (paragraph five, 'To get closer to...').

.....

.....[2]

- (ii) Why is the platform of the buggy so high off the ground?

.....[1]

- (e) Give **one** thing that surprised the writer about the Polar Bear that she saw (paragraph six, 'The first time...').

.....[1]

- (f) **Using your own words**, explain the writer's thoughts about the young male bear that she describes (paragraph seven, 'In the days that followed...').

.....

.....

.....[2]

(g) Re-read paragraphs three and four ('Even in town...fired into the air.') and seven (In the days that followed...innocent, dark eyes.').

(i) Explain **using your own words**, what the writer means by the words in *italics* in **three** of the following phrases:

1. 'a curious bear had *battered* down the front door of a house' (lines 15–16)
2. 'a polar bear *clambered* on to the balcony of my guest-house' (lines 19–20)
3. 'sparring, *lounging*, eating ice to keep cool' (lines 33–34)
4. 'a young male *meandered* under the grille of the platform' (line 35)

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Meaning of the words in *italics*: [1]

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Meaning of the words in *italics*: [1]

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Meaning of the words in *italics*: [1]

(ii) Explain **how** the words and language **in each of the phrases you have chosen in Question (g)(i)** help to suggest the behaviour and attitude of the polar bears.

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Explanation:

.....[2]

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Explanation:

.....[2]

Phrase selected: 1, 2, 3 or 4

Explanation:

.....[2]

[Total: 20]

Question 2

Imagine that you are Michelle Paver, the writer of **Passage A**.

You have been asked to write an article about polar bears **and** the threats that they face for a magazine aimed at teenage readers.

Write your magazine article.

In your magazine article you should:

- say what you have learnt about polar bears
- suggest the precautions that should be taken by visitors to the area
- explain what you gained by visiting such a remote area.

Base your magazine article on what you have read in **Passage A**, but do not copy from it. Be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your magazine article: 'Polar bears are remarkable and impressive creatures...'

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Read carefully **Passage B, *Endangered Animals: Polar Bears***, in the Reading Booklet Insert and answer **Question 3(a)** and **(b)** on this Question Paper.

Question 3

Answer the questions in the order set.

(a) Notes

What do you learn about polar bears **and** the threats to their survival, according to **Passage B**?

Write your answers using short **notes**. **Write one point per line.**

You do not need to use your own words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer.

Information about polar bears and the threats to their survival:

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 10

[10]

(b) Summary

Now use your notes to write a summary of what **Passage B** tells you about polar bears **and** the threats to their survival.

You must use **continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should include all 10 of your points in **Question 3(a)** and must be 100 to 150 words.

Up to 5 marks are available for the quality of your writing.

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[5]

[Total: 15]

[illegible]

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